

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in legal research, knowledge support, document review and case management at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Adobe. Experienced in tracking legal and regulatory developments, preparing procedural documents, maintaining organised matter records and communicating research findings clearly in writing. Developing interest in financial markets and structured finance, supported by self-directed study of private equity mechanics. Seeking a knowledge-focused paralegal role where strong legal research and analytical skills can contribute directly to a transactional finance practice.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction (75%): required tracking regulatory evolution across multiple legal systems and producing a clear, structured written analysis of comparative legal developments
- Modules: international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules: Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law, Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, with partial funding toward the undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Conducted legal research and drafted procedural histories and procedural orders for a complex investment arbitration, producing written outputs used directly in submissions
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a major submission deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions across the matter and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Reviewed and organised large volumes of evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended sections of the memorial under senior supervision
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines; liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes; prepared client-facing research notes
- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, deadline tracking and matter opening and closure across several concurrent matters
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead**July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Researches complex legal and regulatory points across welfare benefits, employment, housing and consumer matters; translates findings into clear written guidance for clients
- Manages matters from instruction to conclusion: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules and maintains confidential case records to deadline
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and advises clients on procedural requirements and options

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech; translated complex statutory requirements into commercially focused written advice
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the submission deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements; reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; regulatory and legislative analysis; concise report and advice writing; document review; electronic bundling; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems.

Self-directed private equity study (Coursera): fund structures, leverage, value creation and exit strategies.

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural history drafting, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters